

PE ACHIEVEMENT STANDARD 3.4

Improving My Game in Pickleball

Module 1 — Lesson 1: Introduction & Programme Design

Module Overview

A rigorous, theoretically grounded approach to skill acquisition and tactical execution on the court.



What This Module Is About

Applying Knowledge & Skills

Appraise baseline outcomes from your pickleball pre-test and gameplay.

Engage in a 10-session performance improvement programme, integrating strategic shot selection and court movement into your play.

Develop tailored tactical plans to optimize performance under game conditions.

Evaluating Knowledge & Skills

Make informed decisions and accurately appraise performance changes after completing your training programme.

Reflect critically on match play to evaluate strategy effectiveness and identify key drivers of skill development.

The Reflective Performer

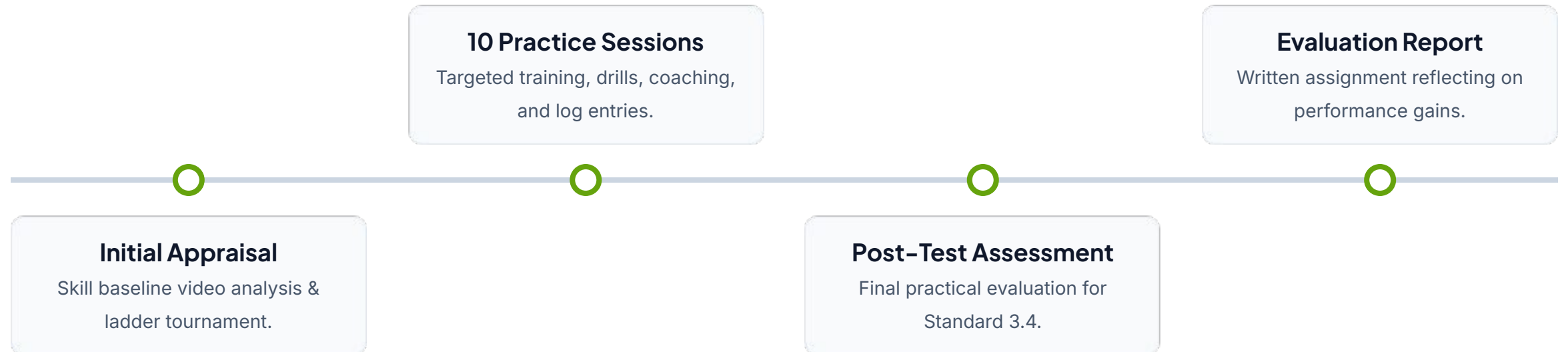
During this module, you are required to become a **reflective learner**, acquiring knowledge *in, through, and about* movement.

Pickleball serves as both a practical medium for skill refinement and a source of analytical data.

You will maintain a reflective journal throughout the unit. Honest self-criticism will provide essential evidence for Task 2 and enable you to think and perform simultaneously in high-pressure rallies.



Practical Session Timeline

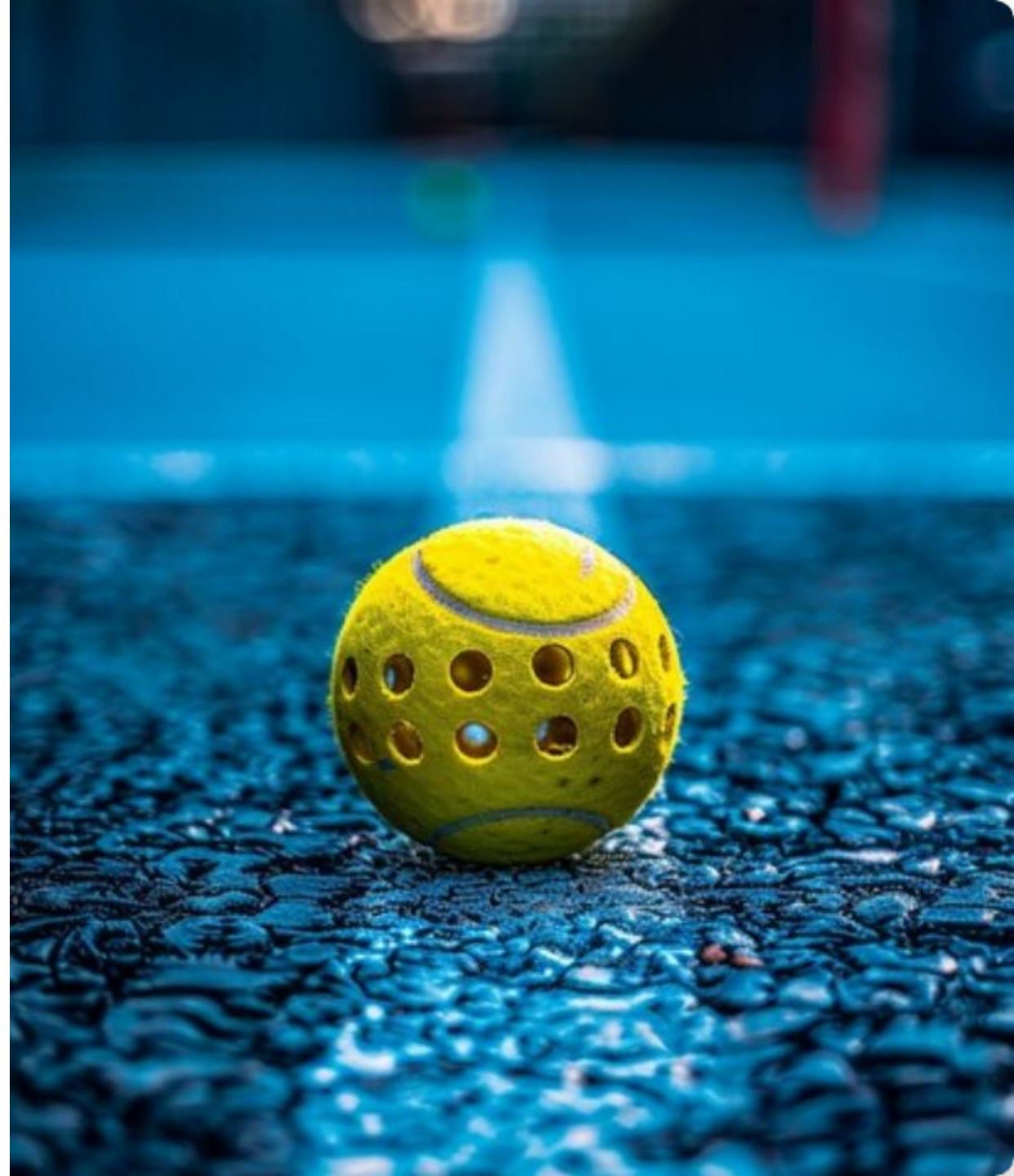


Improvement Programme

Structured Practical Training

You will receive 10 timetabled court sessions to carry out your targeted skill intervention. Structured drill design and specialist coach input will refine your mechanics.

Active participation in correct gear is mandatory. Written progress logs and video evidence from pre and post-tests will substantiate your evaluation report.



Checkpoints & Key Submissions

Assessment Task	Focus & Scope	Key Deliverables
Task 1	Initial Skill Analysis & Baseline Appraisal	Video pre-test & initial baseline log
Task 2	Reflective Journal & Training Log Check	Ongoing session entries & strategy reflections
Task 3	Final Evaluation Report & Performance Appraisal	Post-test analysis & final written report

Pickleball Technical Fundamentals

Essential shot selection, non-volley zone strategy, and official court regulations.



Core Skill Dimensions



The Underhand Serve

Must be hit with an upward arc with paddle contact below the waist.
Direct diagonal placement into opponent service area clearing the kitchen.



Kitchen & Dinking

Soft touch shots dropped into the 7ft Non-Volley Zone (NVZ). Controlling the kitchen line is critical for dominant net play.



3rd Shot Drop & Drives

Transitioning from baseline to net using soft drop shots or deep pace drives to reset control of the rally.

Essential Rules & Faults

Two-Bounce Rule & Scoring

Two-Bounce Rule: The serve must bounce on the receiver's side, and the return must bounce on the server's side before volleys are legal.

Scoring: Played to 11 points (win by 2). In standard side-out scoring, points are earned only by the serving team.

Kitchen Violations & Faults

Non-Volley Zone (Kitchen): You cannot volley a ball while standing on or inside the 7ft kitchen line, or touch the line during follow-through.

Faults: Ball landing out of bounds, failing to clear the net, or stepping into the kitchen during a volley.

Targeted Practical Engagement

10

Dedicated On-Court Sessions

Structure Drives Excellence

Ten timetabled practical periods are allocated for targeted drill progressions, video data gathering, and tactical game simulation. Consistently logging your technical refinements and tactical adaptations across these 10 sessions provides the core evidence needed to achieve top marks in Standard 3.4.

Questions & Discussion

Prepare your gear for the baseline appraisal.

Physical Education Department | Achievement Standard 3.4

Image Sources

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https://www.selkirk.com/cdn/shop/articles/horizontal_3000×2000-2026-SLK-Paddle-Launch-008.jpg?v=1777322174&width=2400

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Source: stockcake.com

Image Sources



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